ChargeGrid AI: India EV Charging Business Case

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The numbers support a strong case for ChargeGrid, but with one important catch: **VW has reportedly paused further India EV investment while it negotiates with JSW.**

Pitch ChargeGrid as a low-cost way to make better charging decisions before that capital is committed, not as a reason to build a network now. Check the JSW and EV plan details internally before presenting them, as most come from press reports.

Problem in India

India's charging network is growing fast, but most of it sits nearly idle: utilisation is 1–5% against the 8–10% needed for viability.

Metric	Number	Source and date
Public charging stations	52,718, including 16,561 with fast chargers for cars	Lok Sabha reply, via ANI, Jul 2026
Oil-company reported stations	27,737 installed, 22,753 operational (18% not operational)	Rajya Sabha reply, Mar 2026
Maharashtra, same dataset	2,243 installed, 1,786 operational (20% not operational)	Rajya Sabha reply, Mar 2026
Utilisation	1–3% (SBI), about 5% (S&P)	Rubix report, Sep 2026
Utilisation needed for viability	8–10%	FICCI, Dec 2024
Chargers below 30 kW	About 73%	Rubix report, Sep 2026
Top 10 states' share of stations	About 78%	Rubix report, Sep 2026
PM E-DRIVE charging scheme	₹2,000 crore for about 72,300 chargers; ₹503.86 crore approved for 4,874	MHI, via press, 2026

Best line for your slide: the ministry told Parliament it has not assessed EV-to-charger adequacy. It also doesn't centrally maintain Tier-2/3 or highway charger data, and it has no three-year roadmap or targets. That is the planning gap ChargeGrid addresses.

Don't apply the 18% to the 52,718 figure, because they come from different datasets.

Market potential

The IEA expects India's public charging points to grow about sixfold by 2035, from 88,000 to more than 520,000.

Metric	Number	Source
Electric car sales, FY26	1,99,923, up 83.6%, 4.2% share	FADA
Electric car sales, Sep 2026	36,108, nearly double a year earlier	FADA
Public charging points	88,000 (2025) to more than 520,000 (2035)	IEA, Current Policies Scenario
Points to add per year	About 43,000, or 3.5 times the 2025 additions	IEA
Capex needed by 2030	₹16,000 crore; start with 40 cities and 20 highway stretches	FICCI
Market revenue	$557 million (2025) to $3.86 billion (2033)	Grand View, via secondary summary

Market forecasts vary widely, from $1.65 billion by 2030 to $45.7 billion by 2035. Use the Grand View figure, about ₹5,350 crore to ₹37,000 crore at ₹96/$, and say that forecasts differ.

Revenue potential

I found no sourced figure for this product, so these are **my estimates, and you should label them that way**.

Value line	Assumption	Result
Charging revenue per 1,000 × 60 kW DC chargers	3% utilisation at ₹18/kWh	₹28 crore/yr
Same chargers	8% utilisation at ₹18/kWh	₹76 crore/yr
Uplift from 3% to 8%	Margin of ₹10/kWh after electricity	**₹47 crore revenue, about ₹26 crore margin/yr**

Value line	Assumption	Result
Software sold to operators	20–40 customers at ₹30–50 lakh/yr	₹6–20 crore/yr
CO_2 credit exposure	117,000 cars at ₹2,500–4,500 per g/km	₹29–53 crore per 1 g/km of shortfall/yr

- **Biggest value:** software alone is a modest business, and the larger value is better capital allocation. Rivals such as Vahanomy, ChargePlanner and Stable already sell site-selection tools.
- **CO_2 row:** it uses draft prices and assumes they apply per car, and I couldn't open the final notification coverage. Confirm both before using it. If your audience works on CO_2 compliance, this row connects ChargeGrid to their work, since each EV sold can earn compliance benefits.
- **Price input:** ₹18/kWh sits at the low end of reported public DC prices.

Why it matters for VW Group

VW's India EV decision is open now, and charging is part of it, so better planning data is useful before money is committed.

- **Timing:** VW and JSW signed a non-binding MoU in Sep 2026, with a reported 51:49 structure and possibly two local EVs by 2028. Further EV investment is reportedly paused pending those talks.
- **Charging is part of the EV decision:** Skoda India linked its 2027–28 EV timing to the supplier base and to charging infrastructure developing. Financial Express framed VW's wait the same way.
- **Volume:** SAVWIPL sold 1,17,000 cars in India in 2025. Its stated goal of 17–20% EVs by 2030 would mean about 20,000–23,000 EVs a year at that volume. That goal dates from May 2025, so check it is still current.
- **Rivals are moving:** Maruti targets 100,000 charging points by 2030, and Hyundai 600+ fast-charging stations by 2032. Tata announced 400,000 points by 2027 with its partners.
- **Group fit:** VW made charging and energy a core business under its NEW AUTO strategy, through Elli and Electrify America.
- **Practical uses:** choose partner networks, prioritise cities and corridors for launch, and estimate grid and solar needs before committing money.

What not to claim

ChargeGrid's current outputs prove the method, not the business result, so keep these limits clear.

- **Pune results are not forecasts:** they run on synthetic VAHAN registrations and placeholder costs. Present "8 sites, ₹10 crore, 11.4% of unmet demand" and the 43-second run as proof of the method only.
- **No proven utilisation gain:** ChargeGrid has no operator data yet, so 8% is a target, not a result. Frame the next step as a pilot using real VAHAN, MSEDCL and operator data.
- **Weak finance results:** the Pune demo's portfolio NPV was about zero, and no site was positive at P50 under the placeholder prices used then. If asked, say the prices aren't real yet and tariffs have since been revised.
- **Expect this challenge:** "Isn't utilisation low because people charge at home?" Partly, yes. Tata found 93% of its EV owners charge at home or work, so better siting helps but can't fix demand alone. The IEA puts home-charging access at 55% of Indian electric car owners, second-lowest of 17 countries. Fleets and highways are the stronger targets.

Sources

Only the first group was read in full. Before presenting, open the others and check each figure you quote.

Read in full

- Rajya Sabha reply, MHI, 27 Mar 2026
- Rubix report, Autocar Professional
- FICCI roadmap press release
- VW–JSW plans, India TV

Preview only (paywalled)

- Why VW is waiting, Financial Express

Search excerpts only (the full page wouldn't open for the first two)

- 52,718 stations, ANI via LatestLY
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- IEA home-charging access, Nagpur Today
- Home charging at 93%, Autocar India
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- FADA FY26, Autocar Professional
- FADA Sep 2026, YourStory
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